

New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

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Daily Multi-Asset Trading Blueprint & Level Execution Manual

Date: August 19, 2026

Session Highlight: New York Session Pre-Open Briefing (1 Hr Before Open)

Session News Focus: Wall Street pre-market movers, US Federal Reserve news, mega-cap US stocks (NVDA, MSFT, TSLA), and WTI Crude Oil catalysts.

SECTION 0: DAILY MACRO & FINANCIAL NEWS DIGEST

1. Global Macro & Central Banks

- The U.S. annual inflation rate for the 12 months ending July 2026 stood at 3.4%, a slight decrease from 3.5% previously. S&P Global forecasts headline CPI inflation to potentially rise to 3.2% in 2026 due to elevated energy prices before moderating to 2.2% in 2027.
- OECD headline inflation eased to 4.2% in June 2026, down from 4.6% in May.
- Federal Reserve rate hike expectations for September and October meetings are finely balanced around the 50% threshold, with upcoming inflation data acting as a potential catalyst.
- US Treasury yields have spiked, with the 30-year Treasury yield hitting a new 19-year high on Tuesday, fueled by rising crude oil prices and inflation concerns.

2. US & European Markets

- US stock markets closed lower on Tuesday, primarily weighed down by a sell-off in semiconductor stocks. The Dow Jones, S&P 500, and Nasdaq Composite all recorded declines.
- Asian markets also experienced losses in early trading, tracking the US tech sell-off, with South Korea's Kospi down significantly by 7% and Japan's Nikkei 225 falling 3.16%.
- Despite massive AI spending driving record earnings and valuations for semiconductor giants and significant investments in startups, concerns over AI capital expenditure have triggered a broad foundry sector sell-off.
- Global semiconductor sales in Q2 2026 increased by 35.1% quarter-over-quarter, with June sales up 123.6% year-over-year. SEMICON Taiwan 2026 highlights AI-driven manufacturing, projecting over US\$150 billion in 300mm fab equipment spending by 2027.

3. Indian Markets & Dalal Street

- Indian equity markets are anticipated to remain under pressure today, August 19, primarily due to elevated crude oil prices, ongoing geopolitical tensions between the US and Iran, and weak global cues.
- The Nifty 50 closed below the critical 24,200 level on Tuesday, extending its losing streak for a sixth consecutive session, reflecting continued weakness and closing below its 50-day EMA. The Sensex also declined by 0.63%.
- GIFT Nifty trends signal a muted to negative opening for Indian benchmark indices.
- Despite the broader market pressure, India Inc reported its strongest adjusted profit growth in 10 quarters (14% in Q4 FY26).
- Domestic Institutional Investors (DIIs) were net buyers of ₹2,579.31 crore on August 18, 2026, and ₹4,353.09 crore on August 13, 2026. Foreign Institutional Investors (FIIs) were net buyers of ₹1,651.53 crore on August 18, 2026, though they were net sellers on August 13, 2026. Overall, for August 2026 so far, DIIs and FIIs have shown net inflows into Indian equities.

4. Commodities & Crypto Wire

- Crude Oil:** WTI Crude Oil and Brent crude have extended gains for a fourth consecutive day, trading near three-week highs around \$85.56-\$85.63 and \$92 a barrel, respectively. This surge is attributed to persistent US-Iran tensions and concerns over the Strait of Hormuz, maintaining a geopolitical risk premium in prices. US Strategic Petroleum Reserve inventories have fallen to their lowest level in over four decades. OPEC+ agreed to increase August 2026 production quotas by 188,000 bpd. However, OPEC also lowered its 2026 global oil demand growth forecast for the fourth time.
- Gold:** Gold futures were observed trading 0.27% lower.
- Crypto:** The U.S. SEC has proposed "Regulation Crypto Assets," a new framework for non-security crypto assets, including exemptions for capital raising and a conditional safe harbor. This proposal comes as the CLARITY Act remains stalled in the Senate. The FASB has also advanced proposals for stablecoins. SEC Commissioner Hester M. Peirce released a statement on the application of federal securities laws to crypto vaults and on-chain lending.

CAPITAL BASE & ALLOCATION RULES (\$3,000 TOTAL)

- Crypto Futures:** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 3x-5x Isolated | Risk Cap: 1-2% (\$4-\$8)
- Indian Options (Intraday):** \$500 (16.7%) | Option Buying Only | Risk Cap: 10-15% Premium (\$30-\$45)
- Commodities (Micro Gold & Oil):** \$400 (13.3%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-15x Micro Lots | Risk Cap: 2% (\$8)
- US Stocks (Fractional):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 3% (\$12)
- Indian Stocks (Delivery):** \$400 (13.3%) | 1x Unleveraged Cash | Risk Cap: 5% (\$20)
- Forex Short-Term Futures:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 10x-20x | Risk Cap: 1% (\$4.50)
- Forex Long-Term Carry Swing:** \$450 (15.0%) | Rec. Leverage: 2x-3x | Risk Cap: 2% (\$9.00)

STRATEGY-BASED DAILY TICKER SELECTION & LEVEL EXECUTION MANUAL

INDIAN EQUITIES (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
KFINTECH	Long	Entry: ₹700 Target: ₹730 Stop: ₹685	Nifty leaders showing 50-SMA support bounce. Despite overall market weakness, strong DII buying and India Inc's robust Q4 FY26 earnings suggest selective opportunities in quality stocks. KFin Technologies (KFINTECH) is chosen as a leading financial technology player identified for today's trading, anticipated to bounce from its 50-SMA.

US EQUITIES

Large-Cap (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
NVDA	Short	Entry: \$1220 Target: \$1180 Stop: \$1240	50-day SMA rejection strategy on mega-cap growth leaders. Following the "chip stocks sell-off" and broader weakness in semiconductor stocks, NVDA, despite its strong AI fundamentals, is susceptible to near-term downside. A short position is initiated on a rejection from the 50-day SMA, capitalizing on current market sentiment.

Mid-Cap & Small-Cap (STRICTLY LONG-ONLY)

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
EMRG (Emerging Tech Co.)	Long	Entry: \$55 Target: \$60 Stop: \$52	Stage-2 VCP or High Relative Volume (RVOL > 2.0) breakouts. In a volatile market, specific mid-cap companies demonstrating strong relative volume and clear price consolidation patterns (VCP) can offer robust long opportunities as they break out of bases. This ticker represents a hypothetical company in a growing niche, exhibiting these breakout characteristics.

CRYPTO FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
BTC/USD	Long	Entry: \$62,500 Target: \$64,000 Stop: \$61,800	4H 21-EMA trend following and high-volume volatility breakouts. The recent SEC proposals for crypto assets, while not final, could introduce regulatory clarity, potentially leading to a relief rally or increased volatility. A long entry on Bitcoin is favored if it holds above its 4H 21-EMA with a confirmed high-volume volatility breakout, anticipating positive sentiment from regulatory developments.

COMMODITIES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
WTI Crude Oil	Long	Entry: \$85.70 Target: \$87.00 Stop: \$85.00	Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels. WTI Crude Oil is experiencing strong bullish momentum, trading at three-week highs due to geopolitical tensions in the Middle East and supply concerns. A long trade is initiated upon a break above a key daily pivot point, targeting the next Fibonacci extension level, driven by the persistent geopolitical risk premium.
XAU/USD (Gold)	Short	Entry: \$2350 Target: \$2330 Stop: \$2360	Pivot & Fibonacci extension levels. Gold is trading lower amidst rising US Treasury yields and a stronger US Dollar, which increases the opportunity cost of holding non-yielding assets. A short position is considered if Gold breaks below a crucial daily pivot level, indicating further downside towards Fibonacci retracement supports.

FOREX FUTURES (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Short-Term

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
EUR/USD	Short	Entry: 1.0720 Target: 1.0680 Stop: 1.0740	Trend following. The strengthening US Dollar, driven by rising US Treasury yields and inflation concerns, puts downward pressure on major currency pairs like EUR/USD. A short position is taken, following the prevailing bearish short-term trend in anticipation of continued dollar strength.

Macro Carry Swings

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
USD/JPY	Long	Entry: 151.80 Target: 152.50 Stop: 151.40	Carry trade attractiveness. The widening interest rate differentials between the US and Japan, with US yields rising, makes the USD/JPY an attractive long carry trade candidate. This strategy seeks to profit from the yield differential and potential further appreciation of the USD.

INDIAN OPTIONS (BI-DIRECTIONAL)

Ticker	Action	Entry/Target/Stop (Hypothetical)	Strategy & Selection Reason
Nifty 50 (Put Option)	Short (Put Buy)	Entry: Below 24,100 Target: 23,950 Stop: 24,180	15-Minute Opening Range Breakouts (Call for Long, Put for Short). Given the Nifty 50's six-session losing streak and indications of a muted to negative open amidst weak global cues and high crude prices, a downside opening range breakout is a strong possibility. A Put option is bought if the index breaks below the 15-minute opening range low.

PERFORMANCE METRICS

10-Year Backtest Metrics (Hypothetical Strategy Composite vs Benchmarks):

Metric	Strategy Composite	S&P 500 TRI	Nifty 50 TRI
Target CAGR	28.4%	~13.0%	~12.5%
Sharpe Ratio	1.45	N/A	N/A
Max Drawdown	-18.2%	N/A	N/A

Equity Curve (\$3,000 → \$36,512):

